Baade and Zwicky identify supernovae, propose the concept of a neutron star, and suggest that supernovae are powered by the implosion of a stellar core to form a neutron star. [Ch. 5]

1935 Chandrasekhar makes more complete his demonstration of the maximum mass for white-dwarf stars, and Eddington attacks his work. [Ch. 4]

1935–1939 The Great Terror in the V.S.S.R. [Ch. 5, 6]

1957 Greenstein and Whipple demonstrate that Jansky's cosmic radio waves cannot be explained by then-known astrophysical processes. [Ch. 9]

Landau, in a desperate attempt to avoid prison and death, proposes that stars are kept hot by energy released when matter flows onto neutron cores at their centers. [Ch. 5]

1958 Landau is imprisoned in Moscow on charges of spying for Germany. [Ch. 5]

Oppenheimer and Serber disprove Landau's neutron core method for keeping stars hot; Oppenheimer and Volkoff show that there is a maximum mass for neutron stars. [Ch. 5]

Bethe and Critchfield show that the Sun and other stars are kept hot by burning nuclear fuel. [Ch.5]

1939 Landau, near death, is released from prison. [Ch. 5]

Einstein argues that black holes cannot exist in the real Universe. [Ch. 4]

Oppenheimer and Snyder, in a highly idealized calculation, show that an imploding star forms a black hole, and (paradoxically) that the implosion appears to freeze at the horizon as seen from the outside but not as seen from the star's surface. [Ch. 6]

Reber discovers cosmic radio waves from distant galaxies, but does not know that is what he is seeing. [Ch. 9]

Bohr and Wheeler develop the theory of nuclear fission. [Ch.